

Aakash 2 to have faster processor, better software

After many delays in the delivery of the Aakash tablet, the government is now giving the upgraded version, Aakash 2, a much-needed face-lift. The world's cheapest tablet made for educational purposes will now get a better processor and the upgraded version of Google's Android OS.

IIT-Bombay, the government's designated nodal agency for the Aakash project, has asked device supplier Datawind for 1,000 tablets with the Android 4.0 version operating system. The tablet will run on a 1 GHz microprocessor, which is expected to be 25 per cent faster than the previous version.

The tablet is likely to go into production in November this year, after which around 100,000 devices will be distributed among university students early next year.

It is worth mentioning here that Datawind had earlier agreed to supply Aakash tablets with Android 2.2 and an 800 MHz microprocessor for Rs 2,276 per piece. However, the company did not comment on the price of the upgraded version.

Update your Android apps 'smartly'

Updating apps from Google Play will now get smarter. Google has introduced what it calls 'Smart App Updates', which is easy on your phone's battery life as well as the amount of data you download.

The concept of updating apps smartly was first announced at the Google I/O developer conference. 'Smart App Updates' allows the user to download only the updated part, which typically is only 30 per cent of the full application. This feature helps in case of big apps or games, which tend to use up a lot of the battery's charge and your data download balance.

Smart App Updates is not dependent on the version of Google Play. It is ruled from the server-side. The feature will also be helpful to telecom operators, since it will take a load off their already congested networks.

The feature will ensure that people can easily access the latest version of an app.

Galaxy Note users can attend calls with the stylus!

Ever thought of talking with a stylus? Well, Samsung has made that possible for you. The Korean smartphone maker has showcased an all-new stylus with Galaxy Note 10.1. It's called the BT S Pen (HM5100).

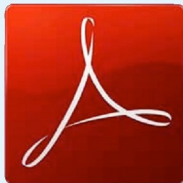
The stylus appears to be the normal S pen that comes with Galaxy Note, but it has different capabilities. This little device includes Bluetooth, a microphone and a speaker. So, you can even attend calls with this 'special' stylus.

The stylus comes with a vibration mechanism. It alerts users of incoming calls. You can then attend the call with the 'call button' placed near the earpiece. Some online reports vouch that the call quality is also good. The BT S Pen provides a talk time of 3 hours, and 130 hours of standby. It can be charged with the AC adapter by plugging in the micro-USB port.

The BT S Pen weighs 21 grams and is Bluetooth 3.0 compatible. So it can be used with other devices as well. The company has not revealed the price and availability of this device so far.

Adobe Reader bug can affect Linux users

Adobe has ignored Linux users while fixing critical memory-related bugs in its Reader. Adobe resolved the issue for Windows and Mac OS X users, leaving Linux users to their own devices in a situation where researchers say that "potential attackers could find enough clues to build an exploit by comparing the current Windows version of Reader with the previous one." One of the major concerns is that Linux users are running the patched versions of Adobe Reader, which contain 16 open security holes.



The warning was issued by Internet search giant, Google, whose employees Mateusz Jurczyk and Gynvael Coldwind initially examined the PDF engine of the Chrome browser and discovered numerous holes. They then tested Adobe Reader and found about 60 issues that triggered crashes, 40 of which are potential attack vectors, according to the *H Open* report.

There is very little that Linux users can do other than deleting the *annots.api* and *PPKLite.api* plug-ins from the */path/to/Adobe/Reader9/Reader/intellinux/plugin_ins* directory. But this will address only two open security holes out of 16.